

Responsibility Governance Standard - (RGS)

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Canonical Definition System

Canonical Definition

Responsibility Governance Standard (RGS) defines the structural conditions under which responsibilities remain assignable, identifiable, traceable, governable, accountable, reconstructable, enforceable, and operationally valid throughout the responsibility lifecycle.

RGS governs responsibility.

The standard establishes the foundational conditions required to determine who was responsible, what they were responsible for, when responsibility existed, how responsibility was assigned, whether responsibility remained valid, and whether responsibility was fulfilled.

Authority grants the right to act.

Responsibility creates the obligation to act.

RGS governs whether responsibility remains valid.

A. Standard Abstract

Every governance system depends on responsibility.

Organizations assign responsibility.

Institutions assign responsibility.

Governments assign responsibility.

Contractor networks assign responsibility.

AI systems increasingly assign responsibility.

Autonomous agents require responsibility governance.

Human-AI operational environments require responsibility governance.

Without responsibility governance:

- obligations become unclear
- responsibility gaps emerge
- accountability becomes difficult
- ownership disappears
- governance failures increase
- operational reliability decreases

RGS exists to govern these conditions.

B. Core Principle

Responsibility becomes valid only when responsibility assignments remain identifiable, traceable, governable, accountable, reconstructable, enforceable, and operationally valid throughout the responsibility lifecycle.

C. Scope

This standard may apply to:

- organizations
 - institutions
 - governments
 - regulatory environments
 - contractor networks
 - subcontractor chains
 - temporary workforce environments
 - supervisory systems
 - operational environments
 - AI systems
 - autonomous agents
 - orchestrated agent systems
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- Human-AI governance environments
- robotics ecosystems
- future intelligent governance systems

RGS applies wherever responsibility exists.

D. Why This Standard Exists

Many governance failures originate from responsibility ambiguity.

Common examples include:

- unclear ownership
- responsibility conflicts
- responsibility gaps
- overlapping responsibilities
- abandoned responsibilities
- delegated responsibilities without oversight
- contractor-chain ambiguity
- Human-AI responsibility uncertainty

The challenge is not assigning responsibility.

The challenge is preserving responsibility integrity.

RGS exists because responsibility governance has become a distinct governance space.

E. Responsibility Integrity Logic

Responsibility integrity exists only when the following remain materially preservable:

1. Responsibility Assignment Origin Integrity

Responsibility remains attributable to a legitimate assignment source.

2. Responsibility Scope Integrity

Responsibility remains connected to clearly defined obligations and boundaries.

3. Responsibility Validity Integrity

Responsibility remains legitimate, recognized, and operationally valid.

4. Responsibility Traceability Integrity

Responsibility remains reconstructable throughout the responsibility lifecycle.

5. Responsibility Accountability Integrity

Responsibility remains connected to accountable governance structures and consequences.

F. Operational Architecture Space

RGS defines the operational architecture space for:

- responsibility governance
- responsibility assignment
- responsibility ownership
- responsibility boundaries
- responsibility traceability
- responsibility accountability
- responsibility fulfillment
- responsibility continuity
- contractor responsibility governance
- Human-AI responsibility governance
- agent responsibility governance

This space exists because governance requires clarity regarding who was obligated to act.

RGS governs whether responsibility remains valid.

G. Difference Between Authority and Responsibility

Authority defines what an actor may do.

Responsibility defines what an actor must do.

Authority grants rights.

Responsibility creates obligations.

Authority may exist without responsibility.

Responsibility may exist without authority.

Both must remain governable.

AGS governs authority.

RGS governs responsibility.

H. Runtime Position

RGS operates as the sixth foundational layer of AGA™.

It follows:

- Relationship Accountability Standard (RAS)
- Authority Governance Standard (AGS)
- Authority Delegation Standard (ADS)
- Authority Validation Standard (AVS)
- Authority Escalation Standard (AES)

and supports:

- Capability Readiness Governance Standard (CRGS)
- Chain of Control Standard (CCS)
- Governance Oversight Standard (GOS)
- Evidence Accountability Standard (EAS)
- Accountability Governance Standard (AGS-A)

RGS governs who was obligated to act.

I. Responsibility Failure Rule

Responsibility failure occurs when responsibility assignments cannot be reliably identified, reconstructed, governed, fulfilled, enforced, or connected to accountable governance structures.

Examples include:

- responsibility gaps
- unclear ownership
- abandoned responsibilities
- undocumented responsibility transfers
- responsibility conflicts
- contractor-chain ambiguity
- Human-AI responsibility failures
- unfulfilled obligations

RGS exists to expose and govern these conditions.

J. Validity Logic

A responsibility-governance environment is valid under RGS when:

- responsibility assignments remain identifiable
- responsibility scope remains visible
- responsibility legitimacy remains demonstrable
- responsibility history remains reconstructable
- responsibility accountability remains preservable
- responsibility fulfillment remains reviewable

- responsibility governance remains operationally valid

A responsibility-governance environment becomes invalid when:

- responsibility cannot be identified
- responsibility scope is unclear
- responsibility legitimacy disappears
- responsibility history cannot be reconstructed
- responsibility accountability is lost
- responsibility obligations become unverifiable

K. Relationship to Other OOF Standards

RGS derives from:

- Relationship Accountability Standard (RAS)
- Authority Governance Standard (AGS)
- Authority Delegation Standard (ADS)
- Authority Validation Standard (AVS)
- Authority Escalation Standard (AES)

and supports:

- Capability Readiness Governance Standard (CRGS)
- Chain of Control Standard (CCS)
- Governance Oversight Standard (GOS)
- Evidence Accountability Standard (EAS)
- Accountability Governance Standard (AGS-A)
- Chain of Accountability Protocol (CAP™)

Authority determines who may act.

Responsibility determines who must act.

RGS governs that obligation.

L. Foundational Principle

Governance cannot function if responsibility cannot be identified.

Canonical Closing Statement

Responsibility Governance Standard (RGS) defines the structural conditions under which responsibilities remain assignable, identifiable, traceable, governable, accountable, reconstructable, enforceable, and operationally valid throughout the

responsibility lifecycle.

Authority may define what actors are allowed to do, but responsibility defines what actors are obligated to do. Governance therefore depends not only on authority, but on the ability to identify, govern, trace, and enforce responsibility throughout operational reality.

Module Architecture

→ RAOIM — Responsibility Assignment Origin Integrity Module

→ RSCIM — Responsibility Scope Integrity Module

→ RVIM — Responsibility Validity Integrity Module

→ RTIM — Responsibility Traceability Integrity Module

→ RAIM — Responsibility Accountability Integrity Module

Related Documents

→ About the Responsibility Governance Standard - (RGS)

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Canonical Source

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